

Borla

User Manual

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Course: CSCD 602 — Advanced Software Engineering, University of Ghana

Document: User_Manual.pdf · Version 1.0 · 13 August 2026

1. What Borla is

Borla connects households that have waste to dispose of with nearby collectors who are online and looking for work. There are two ways to get matched:

- **Broadcast** — tap "I HAVE WASTE" and every nearby online collector sees a pin on their map. Whoever gets there first collects it; you clear the pin the moment someone shows up.
- **Direct request** — pick one specific collector from the map and send them a request; they accept or reject it, and if they accept, you can both see and call each other.

Borla is a real installable web app (a PWA): after logging in, open **Profile** and tap **Install Borla app** to add it to your home screen with its own icon, launching full-screen like a native app (Chrome/Edge/Android; on iPhone, use Safari's Share → **Add to Home Screen** instead, since iOS doesn't offer the same in-app install button). When a new version is deployed, a banner appears at the bottom of the screen offering to **Update** — nothing changes under you without asking first.

2. Logging in (all roles) — one unified flow

There is a single entry point for everyone. You never have to say upfront whether you're a household, a collector, or an admin — **your phone number tells the app who you are**:

1. Open the app's URL (see `Deployment_and_Source_Links.txt`). You land on the welcome/splash screen — tap **Get started**.
2. Enter your phone number and tap **Continue**. That's the only field on this screen — no role picker, no "Admin" toggle to find.
3. What happens next depends on the number itself:
 - **It's a seeded admin's number** → you're taken straight to a password field ("This number is registered as an admin — sign in with your password"). Enter the password and tap **Sign in**. See §5 for the admin credentials.
 - **Anything else** → a one-time code is sent.
4. **If SMS delivery is configured and working**, a text arrives with your 6-digit code and the screen simply says "Code sent via SMS — check your phone."
5. **If SMS delivery isn't available** (no gateway configured, or the send failed), the screen shows the code directly in a dark banner labelled "SMS delivery unavailable right now" — this is a documented, deliberate fallback (see `Technical_Debt_Plan.md` TD-02), not a bug: nobody is ever locked out just because a text didn't arrive.
 - **Exception — the two seeded demo numbers** (`Deployment_and_Source_Links.txt`): since those numbers are arbitrary, not real handsets, they always use the same fixed code (**482913**) and the app never even attempts a real SMS send to them, so grading never depends on a text reaching a phone that doesn't exist. Any other, real phone number still gets a genuine random code.
6. Type the 6-digit code.
 - **Brand-new number** → the screen also asks "First time here — tell us a bit about you": pick **Household** or **Collector** and enter your name, then tap **Create account**.
 - **Number you've used before** → there's nothing else to fill in; tap **Verify & continue** and you're straight in.

3. Household walkthrough

1. After login you land on your **Home** screen: a map centred on your current location (allow location access when the browser asks), with green dots for nearby online collectors.
2. **To broadcast**: tap the big gold "🔔 **I HAVE WASTE**" button, optionally pick a waste type and add a short note, then **Confirm — I have waste**. A banner shows how many collectors were notified. The pin auto-expires after 45 minutes if you forget it.
3. **The moment someone comes for it**: tap **Clear pin** on the sticky banner — this removes it from every collector's map immediately, so nobody else wastes a trip.
4. **To request one specific collector**: scroll to "Nearby collectors," pick one, and tap **Request**. Your request appears under "My requests" with a status chip: *Sent* → *Seen* → *Accepted/Rejected/No response*.
5. **Once accepted**: tap **Show contact** to reveal the collector's phone number and call them directly. You'll also see a 🌟 **Leave a review** option — rate 1–5 and optionally comment; it becomes public once it passes moderation and the other side has also reviewed (or after the review window closes).
6. **Profile tab**: adjust your alert radius and whether standing alerts are on; see reviews collectors have left about you.

4. Collector walkthrough

1. After login you land on your **Home** screen, offline by default.
2. **New collector accounts start unverified** — you'll see a banner saying an admin must approve you before you can go online. This is a deliberate anti-abuse gate (only verified collectors ever receive broadcasts); ask an admin to verify your account (§5).
3. **Go online**: tap **Go online** (allow location access). Your position updates while the tab stays open in the foreground — this build has no native background-location service, so locking your phone or switching apps pauses updates (documented in `Technical_Debt_Plan.md` TD-O3; keep the tab open and the screen on while actively collecting).
4. **Nearby waste**: active pins appear on your map and in the list below it, closest first, with a one-tap 📞 **Call** button.
5. **Incoming direct requests**: appear as a card with **Accept/Reject**. Accepting reveals the household's phone number to both of you and lets you leave a review afterwards.
6. **Go offline** when you're done — this immediately removes you from the matchable set.

5. Admin walkthrough

1. At the sign-in screen, enter the admin's phone number and tap **Continue** — there is no separate admin toggle to find; the app recognises the number and shows a password field instead of sending an OTP ("This number is registered as an admin — sign in with your password").
2. Enter the password (see `Deployment_and_Source_Links.txt` for the seeded demo admin credentials) and tap **Sign in**.
3. You land on **Admin — Ops console** with six tabs:
 - **Stats**: online collectors, users by role, broadcasts/requests by status, moderation backlog.
 - **Map**: live view of active pins (gold) and online collectors (green).
 - **Users**: search, **Verify** a collector (required before they can go online), or **Suspend/Reinstate** any account.
 - **Moderation**: AI-flagged/user-reported items to **Clear** or **Remove**, plus anything still awaiting moderation entirely (shown here whenever no `GEMINI_API_KEY` is configured) with a one-click **Approve**.
 - **Audit**: every privileged action taken by any admin, with a timestamp.

- **Config:** live-editable operational settings (pin TTL, broadcast radius, request timeout, review window) — changes apply immediately, no redeploy.

6. Redeploying / rolling back

The app auto-builds from the `main` branch of the connected GitHub repository. To ship a change: push to `main`; Render rebuilds and redeploys automatically. To roll back: in the Render dashboard, open the service → **Events/Deploys** tab → pick an earlier successful deploy → **Redeploy**. Database migrations run automatically on server boot (`server/src/db/migrate.ts`) and are additive/idempotent — rolling the *app* back does not roll the *schema* back, so avoid rolling back past a deploy that introduced a schema change unless you also revert `server/migrations/`.

7. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
"Your collector account is not verified yet"	New collector account, not yet admin-approved	Log in as admin → Users → Verify
No collectors/pins showing on the map	Location permission denied, or nobody online nearby	Allow location access; try again once a collector/household is nearby in the seed data
OTP screen shows the code instead of "sent via SMS"	SMS gateway not configured or the send failed	Expected fallback — use the shown code; see <code>Technical_Debt_Plan.md</code> TD-02
Reviews never appear on a profile	Awaiting moderation and/or the other side hasn't reviewed yet	Check Admin → Moderation; double-blind release also waits up to the configured review window
Build fails on Render with "vite: not found"	<code>NODE_ENV=production</code> made <code>npm ci</code> skip devDependencies	Already fixed in <code>render.yaml</code> (<code>--include=dev</code> on the build command)